

lers, and said vnto them, You exact vsurie, euery one of his brother. And I set a great assembly against them:

*Leuit 25.
48.

8 And I said vnto them, We, after our abilitie, haue* redeemed our brethren the Iewes, which were sold vnto the heathen; and will you euen sell your brethren: or shall they be sold vnto vs: Then held they their peace, and found nothing to answer.

9 Also I said, It is not good that yee doe: ought yee not to walke in the feare of our God, because of the reproch of the heathen our enemies:

10 I likewise, and my brethren, and my seruants, might exact of them money and come: I pray you let vs leaue off this vsurie.

11 Restoze, I pray you, to them, euen this day, their lands, their vineyards, their oliue-yards, and their houses, also the hundredth part of the money, and of the corne, the wine, and the oyle, that ye exact of them.

12 Then said they, Wee will restore them, and will require nothing of them; so will we doe, as thou sayest. Then I called the Priests, and tooke an oath of them, that they should doe according to this promise.

13 Also I thooke my lap, and said, So God shake out euery man from his house, and from his labour, that performeth not this promise, euen thus be he shaken out, and† emptied. And all the Congregation said, Amen, and praised the LORD. And the people did according to this promise.

† Heb. empty
or void.

14 Moreover, from the time that I was appointed to be their gouernor in the land of Iudah, from the twentieth yere euen vnto the two and thirtieth yere of Artaxerxes the king, that is, twelue yeres, I and my brethren, haue not eaten the bread of the gouernour:

15 But the former gouernours that had bene before me, were chargeable vnto the people, and had taken of them bread, and wine, beside fourtie shekels of silver, yea euen their seruants bare rule ouer the people: but so did not I, because of the feare of God.

16 Pca also I continued in the worke of this wall, neither bought wee any land: and all my seruants were gathered thither vnto the worke.

17 Moreover, there were at my table, an hundred and fiftie of the Iewes and rulers, besides those that came vnto vs from among the heathen that are about vs.

18 Now that which was prepared for me daily, was one oxe, and fise choise sheepe; also fowles were prepared for mee, and once in ten dayes, store of all sorts of wine: yet for all this required not I the bread of the gouernour, because the bondage was heauy vpon this people.

19 *Thinke vpon mee, my God, for good, according to all that I haue done for this people.

* Chap 13.
22.

CHAP. VI.

1 Sanballat practiseth by craft, by rumours, by hired prophecies, to terrifie Nehemiah. 15 The worke is finished to the terrour of the enemies. 17 Secret intelligence passeth betweene the enemies, and the nobles of Iudah.

NOW it came to passe when Sanballat, and Tobiah, and Gethem the Arabian, and the rest of our enemies heard, that I had builded the wall, and that there was no breach left therein: (though at that time I had not set vp the doozes vpon the gates.)

2 That Sanballat, and Gethem sent vnto me, saying, Come, let vs meet together in some one of the villages in the plaine of Ono: But they thought to doe me mischief.

3 And I sent messengers vnto them, saying, I am doing a great worke, so that I can not come dolvn: why should the worke cease, whilst I leaue it, and come dolvne to you?

4 Yet they sent vnto me foure times, after this sort: and I answered them after the same maner.

5 Then sent Sanballat his servant vnto me, in like manner, the fifth time, with an open letter in his hand:

6 wherein was written; It is reported among the heathen, and || Gathenu sayth it, that thou and the Iewes thinke to rebell: for which cause thou buildest the wall, that thou mayest be their King, according to these wordes.

|| Or, Gethem, ver. 2.

7 And thou hast also appointed prophets to preach of thee at Ierusalem, saying, There is a King in Iudah. And now shall it be reported to the king, according to these wordes. Come now therefore, and let vs take counsell together.

8 Then I sent vnto him, saying, There are no such things done as thou sayest, but thou feignest them out of thine owne heart.

9 For they all made vs afraid, saying, Their handes shall be weakened from the worke that it bee not done. Now therefore, O God, strengthen my hands.

10 Afterward I came vnto the house of Shemaiah the sonne of Delaiah, the sonne of Shehetael, who was shut vp, and he said, Let vs meet together in the house of God, within the Temple, and let vs shut the doores of the Temple: for they will come to slay thee, yea in the night wil they come to slay thee.

11 And I said, Should such a man as I, flee: and who is there, that being as I am, would goe into the Temple to saue his life: I will not goe in.

12 And loe, I perceiued that God had not sent him, but that he pronounced this propheticke against mee: for Tobiah, and Sanballat had hired him.

13 Therefore was hee hired, that I should be afraid, and doe so, and lyme, and that they might haue matter for an euill report, that they might reproch mee.

14 By God, thinke thou vpon Tobiah, and Sanballat, according to these their workes, and on the prophetesse Noadiah, and the rest of the prophets, that would haue put me in feare.

15 So the wall was finished, in the twentie and fifti day of the moneth Elul, in fiftie and two dayes.

16 And it came to passe that when all our enemies heard thereof, and all the heathen, that were about vs, saw these things, they were much cast downe in their owne eyes: for they perceiued that this worke was wrought of our God.

† Hebr. multiplied: trespassing to Tobiah.

17 Moreover, in those dayes the nobles of Iudah † sent many letters vnto Tobiah, and the letters of Tobiah came vnto them.

18 For there were many in Iudah sworne vnto him: because hee was the sonne in law of Shehaniah the sonne of Arah, and his sonne Johanan had taken the daughter of Meshullam, the sonne of Berechiah.

|| Or, matters.

19 Also they reported his good deeds before me, and vttered my || wordes to him: and Tobiah sent letters to put me in feare.

CHAP. VII.

1 Nehemiah committeth the charge of Ierusalem to Hanani and Hananiah. 5 A register of the genealogie of them which came at the first out of Babylon, 9 of the people. 39 of the Priests. 43 of the Leuites. 46 of the Nethinims. 57 of Solomons seruants. 63 and of the Priests which could not find their pedegree. 66 The whole number of them, with their substance. 70 Their oblations.

NOW it came to passe when the wall was built, and I had set vp the doores, and the porters, and the singers, and the Leuites were appointed,

2 That I gaue my brother Hanani, and Hananiah the ruler of the palace, charge ouer Ierusalem (for hee was a faithfull man, and feared God aboue many.)

3 And I said vnto them, Let not the gates of Ierusalem be opened, vntill the Sunne bee hot; and while they stand by, let them shut the doores, and barre them. And appoint watches of the inhabitants of Ierusalem, euery one in his watch, and euery one to bee ouer against his house.

4 Now the city was large and great, but the people were few therein, and the houses were not builded.

† Hebr. broad in spaces.

5 And my God put into mine heart, to gather together the nobles, and the rulers, & the people, that they might be reckoned by genealogie. And I found a register of the genealogie of them which came vp at the first, and found written therein;

6 These are the children of the province, that went vp out of the captiuitie, of those that had bene caried away whom Nebuchadnezzar the King of Babylon had caried away, and came againe to Ierusalem and to Iudah, euery one vnto his citie:

* Ezra. 2. 1. &c.

7 Who came with Zerubbabel, Iesua, Nehemiah, || Azariah, Baamiah, Bahamian, Mordecai, Bilshan, Mi-pereth, Bignai, Rahum, Baanah. The number, I say, of the men of the people of Irael, was this:

|| Or, Seraiab.

8 The children of Parosh, two thousand, an hundred, seuentie and two.

9 The children of Shephatiah, three hundred, seuentie and two.

10 The children of Arah, sixe hundred, fiftie and two.

11 The

11 The children of Pahath-Boab, of the children of Ieshua, and Boab, two thousand, and eight hundred, and eightene.

12 The children of Elam, a thousand, two hundred, fiftie and foure.

13 The children of Zattu, eight hundred fourtie and fve.

14 The children of Zaccai, seven hundred and threescore.

|| Or, Bani.

15 The children of || Binnui, six hundred, fourty and eight.

16 The children of Bebai, six hundred, twentie and eight.

17 The children of Azgad, two thousand, three hundred, twentie and two.

18 The children of Adonikam, six hundred, threescore and seven.

19 The children of || Siguai, two thousand, threescore and seven.

20 The children of Adin, six hundred, fiftie and fve.

21 The children of Ater of Hezekiah, ninetie and eight.

22 The children of Hashum, three hundred, twentie and eight.

23 The children of Bezai, three hundred twentie and foure.

|| Or, Iora.

24 The children of || Hariph, an hundred and twelue.

|| Or, Giebar.

25 The children of || Gibeon, ninetie and fve.

26 The men of Bethlehem, and Netophah, an hundred, fourescore and eight.

27 The men of Anathoth, an hundred, twentie and eight.

|| Or, Azma-
ueth.

28 The men of || Bethazmaueth, fourtie and two.

|| Or, Kiri-
ath-arim.

29 The men of || Biriath-tearim, Chephirah and Beeroth, seven hundred fourtie and three.

30 The men of Ramah and Geba, six hundred, twentie and one.

31 The men of Michmash, an hundred and twenty and two.

32 The men of Bethel and Ai, an hundred, twentie and three.

33 The men of the other Rebo, fiftie and two.

* See ver. 12.

34 The children of the other* Elam, a thousand, two hundred, fiftie & foure.

35 The children of Harim, three hundred and twentie.

36 The children of Jericho, three hundred, fourtie and fve.

37 The children of Lod, Hadid, and Ono, seven hundred, twentie and one.

38 The children of Senaa, three

thousand, nine hundred, and thirty.

39 ¶ The Priests. The children of * Jedaia, of the house of Ieshua, nine hundred, seuentie and three.

* 1. Chro.
24.7.

40 The children of Immer, a thousand, fiftie and two.

41 The children of Paschur, a thousand, two hundred, fourtie and seven.

42 The children of Harim, a thousand, and seuentene.

43 ¶ The Levites. The children of Ieshua, of Kadmiel, and of the children of || Hodeuah, seuentie and foure.

|| Or, Hoda-
uab, Ezra
2.4. Or, In-
dab, Ezra.
3.9

44 ¶ The singers. The children of Asaph, an hundred, fourtie and eight.

45 ¶ The porters. The children of Shallum, the children of Ater, the children of Talmon, the children of Akkub, the children of Hatita, the children of Shobai, an hundred, thirtie and eight.

46 ¶ The Bethunims. The children of Ziba, the children of Hashupha, the children of Tabaoth,

47 The children of Beros, the children of Sia, the children of Padon,

48 The children of Lebana, the children of Hagaba, the children of Shalmai,

49 The children of Hanan, the children of Giddel, the children of Sahar,

50 The children of Beai, the children of Rezin, the children of Nekoda,

51 The children of Gazzani, the children of Uzza, the children of Phaseah,

52 The children of Besai, the children of Meunim, the children of Nephtesim,

53 The children of Bakbuk, the children of Hakupha, the children of Harhur,

54 The children of Baslith, the children of Meshida, the children of Harsha,

55 The children of Barkos, the children of Sisera, the children of Tamah,

56 The children of Neziel, the children of Hatipha.

57 ¶ The children of Solomons seruants: The children of Sotai, the children of Sophereth, the children of Perida,

58 The children of Jaala, the children of Darkon, the children of Giddel,

59 The children of Shephatiah, the children of Hattai, the children of Poche-
reth Zebai, the children of || Amoi,

Or, Ami.

60 All the Bethunims, and the children of Solomons seruants, were three hundred ninetie and two.

61 * And these were they which went

* Ezra 2.
43.

Gifts to the worke. Nehemiah. The Law is read.

CHAP. VIII.

1 The religious maner of reading and hearing the Law. 9 They comfort the people. 13 The forwardnesse of them to heare and be instructed. 16 They keepe the feast of Tabernacles.

AND all the people gathered themselves together, as one man, into the street that was before the water gate,* and they spake vnto Ezra the scribe, to bring the booke of the Law of Moses, which the LORD had commanded to Israel.

* Ezra 3. 1. and 7. 6.

2 And Ezra the priest brought the Law before the Congregation, both of men and women, and all† that could heare with vnderstanding, vpon the first day of the seuenth moneth.

† Heb. that vnderstood in hearing.

3 And hee read therein before the street that was before the water gate,† from the morning vntill nidday, before the men and the women, and those that could vnderstand: And the eares of all the people were attentue vnto the booke of the law.

† Heb. from the light.

4 And Ezra the scribe, stood vpon a pulpit of wood, which they had made for the purpose, and beside him stood Matithiah, and Shema, and Ananiah, and Uriah, and Hilkiah, and Maaseiah, on his right hand: and on his left hand, Gedaliah, and Shihai, and Bahchiah, and Hashum, and Hashbadana, Zechariah, and Meshullam.

† Heb. towre of wood.

5 And Ezra opened the booke in the† sight of all the people (for hee was aboue al the people) and when he opened it, all the people stood vp:

† Hebr. eyes.

6 And Ezra blessed the LORD the great God: and al the people answered, Amen, Amen, with lifting vp their hands: and they bowed their heads, and worshipped the LORD, with their faces to the ground.

7 Also Ieshua and Bani, and Sherebiah, Jamin, Akkub, Shabbethai, Hodajah, Maaseiah, Kelita, Azariah, Jozabad, Hanan, Delaiah, and the Leuites, caused the people to vnderstand the law: and the people stood in their place.

8 So they read in the booke, in the Law of God distinctly, and gaue the sense, and caused them to vnderstand the reading.

9 And Nehemiah, which is the Tirshatha, and Ezra the Priest the Scribe, and the Leuites that taught the

|| Or, the governor.

by also from Tel-Melah, Tel-Haresa, Cherub, Addon, and Immer: but they could not shewe their fathers house, nor their seede, whether they were of Israel.

|| Or, pedegrees

62 The children of Delaiah, the children of Tobiah, the children of Nekoda, sixe hundred fourtie and two.

63 And of the priests: the children of Ihabaiah, the children of Buz, the children of Barzillai, which tooke one of the daughters of Barzillai the Gileadite to wife, and was called after their name.

64 These sought their register, among those that were reckoned by genealogie, but it was not found: therefore were they, as polluted, put from the priesthood.

|| Or, the governor.

65 And the Tirshatha said vnto them, that they should not eate of the most holy things, till there stood vp a priest with Urin and Thummim.

66 The whole congregation together, was fourtie and two thousand, three hundred and threescore:

67 Beside their man seruants, and their maid seruants, of whome there were seuen thousand, three hundred, thirtie and seuen: and they had two hundred fourtie and fve singing men and singing women.

68 Their horses, seuen hundred, thirtie and sixe: their mules, two hundred fourtie and fve:

69 Their camels, foure hundred thirtie and fve: sixe thousand, seuen hundred and twentie asses.

† Hebr. part.

70 And some of the chiefe of the fathers, gaue vnto the worke: The Tirshatha gaue to the treasure, a thousand drammes of gold, fiftie balons, fve hundred and thirtie priests garments.

71 And some of the chiefe of the fathers gaue to the treasure of the worke twentie thousand drammes of golde, and two thousand and two hundred pound of siluer.

72 And that which the rest of the people gaue, was twentie thousand drammes of gold, and two thousand pound of siluer, and threescore and seuen priests garments.

73 So the priests, and the Leuites, and the porters, and the singers, and some of the people, and the Bethunims, and all Israel, dwelt in their cities: And when the seuenth moneth came, the children of Israel were in their cities.

the people, said vnto all the people, This day is holy vnto the LORD your God, mourne not, nor weepe: for all the people wept, when they heard the words of the Law.

10 Then hee sayd vnto them, Goe your way, eat the fat, & drinke the sweet, and send portions vnto them, for whom nothing is prepared: for this day is holy vnto our LORD: neither be ye sorry, for the ioy of the LORD is your strength.

11 So the Leuites stilled all the people, saying, holde your peace, for the day is holy, neither be ye grieved.

12 And all the people went their way to eate, and to drinke, and to send portions, and to make great mirth, because they had vnderstood the wordes that were declared vnto them.

13 And on the second day were gathered together the chiefe of the fathers of all the people, the Priestes and the Leuites, vnto Ezra the Scribe, euen to vnderstand the wordes of the Law.

14 And they found written in the Law which the LORD had commanded by Moses, that the children of Israel should dwell in * boothes, in the feast of the seuenith moneth:

15 And that they should publish and proclaime in all their cities, and in Ierusalem, saying, Goe forth vnto the mount, and fetch Oliue branches, and pine branches, and Myrtle branches, and palme branches, and branches of thicke trees, to make boothes, as it is written.

16 So the people went forth, and brought them, and made themselves boothes, euery one vpon the roofof his house, and in their courts, and in the courts of the house of God, and in the streete of the water-gate, and in the streete of the gate of Ephraim.

17 And all the congregation of them that were come againe out of the captiuitie, made boothes, and late vnder the boothes: for since the dayes of Ieshua the sonne of Nun, vnto that day, had not the children of Israel done so: and there was very great gladnesse.

18 Also day by day from the first day vnto the last day, he read in the booke of the Law of God: and they kept the feast seuen dayes, and on the eight day was † a solemne assembly according vnto the maner.

C H A P. IX.

1 A solemne Fast, and repentance of the people. 4 The Leuites make a religious confession of Gods goodnes, and their wickednes.

NOW in the * twentie and fourth day of this moneth, the children of Israel were assembled with fasting, & with sackclothes, and earth vpon them.

2 And the seede of Israel separated themselves from all † strangers, and stood and confessed their sinnes, and the iniquities of their fathers.

3 And they stood vp in their place, and read in the booke of the Law of the LORD their God, one fourth part of the day, and another fourth part they confessed and worshipped the LORD their God.

4 Then stood vp, vpon the † staires of the Leuites, Ieshua and Bani, Kadmiel, Shebaniah, Bunni, Sherebiah, Bani, and Chenani, and cryed with a loude voice vnto the LORD their God.

5 Then the Leuites, Ieshua and Kadmiel, Bani, hathabmah, Sherebiah, Hoduah, Shebaniah, and Pethahiah, sayde, Stand vp, and blesse the LORD your God for euer and euer, and blessed bee thy glorious Name, which is exalted aboue all blessing and praise.

6 Thou, euen thou art LORD alone, * thou hast made heauen, the heauen of heauens, with all their hoste, the earth, and all things that are therein, the seas, and all that is therein, and thou preferrest them all, and the hoste of heauen worshippeth thee.

7 Thou art the LORD the God, who diddest choose * Abzani, and broughtest him forth out of Ur of the Chaldees, and gauest him the name of Abraham:

8 And foundest his heart * faithfull before thee, & madest a * couenant with him, to giue the land of the Canaanites, the Hittites, the Amorites, and the Perizzites, and the Jebusites, and the Girgashites, to giue it, I say, to his seed, and hast performed thy words, for thou art righteous,

9 * And didst see the affliction of our fathers in Egypt, and heardest their cry by the red Sea,

10 And shewedst signes * and wonders

* Chap. 8. 2

† Heb. strange children.

|| Or, seafold.

* Gen. 1. 1.

* Gen. 11. 31. and 12. 5. & 17. 5.

* Gen. 15. 6.

* Gen. 12. 17. and 15. 18. & 17. 9.

* Exod. 2. 7. and 14. 10.

* Exod. 7. 8. 9, 10, 12, & 14. chapters

|| Or, that they might instruct in the words of the Law.
† Heb. by the hand of.
* Leuit. 23. 34. deut. 16. 13.

† Heb. arc-strait.

Gods benefits. Nehemiah. Mans ingratitude.

	ders vpon Pharaoh, and on all his seruants, and on all the people of his land: for thou knewest that they dealt proudly against them: so didst thou get thee a name, as it is this day. 11 * And thou didst diuide the sea before them, so that they went through the midst of the sea on the drie land, and their persecutours thou threwest into the deepes, as a stone into the mighty waters. 12 Moreover thou * leddest them in the day by a cloudy pillar, and in the night, by a pillar of fire, to giue them light in the way wherein they should go. 13 Thou * camest downe also vpon mount Sinai, and spakest with them from heauen, and gauest them right iudgements, and † true lawes, good statutes and commandements: 14 And inadest knowen vnto them thy holy Sabbath, and commandedst them precepts, statutes, and lawes, by the hand of Moses thy seruant: 15 And * gauest them bread from heauen for their hunger, and broughtest forth water for them out of the rocke, for their thirst, and promisedst them that they should * goe in to possesse the land, † which thou hadst swozne to giue them. 16 But they and our fathers dealt proudly, and hardened their necks, and hearkned not to thy commandements: 17 And refused to obey, neither were mindful of the wonders that thou didst among them: but hardened their necks, and in their rebellion appointed * a captain to returne to their bondage: but thou art † a God ready to pardon, gracious and mercifull, slow to anger, and of great kindness, & forsookest them not. 18 Psea * When they had made them a molten calfe, and said, This is thy God, that brought thee by out of Egypt, and had wrought great prouocations: 19 Yet thou, in thy manifold mercies, forsookest them not in the wilderness: the * pillar of the cloude departed not from them by day, to leade them in the way, neither the pillar of fire by night, to shew them light, and the way wherein they should goe. 20 Thou gauest also thy * good spirit, to instruct them, and withheldest not thy * Manna from their mouth, and gauest them water for their thirst. 21 Psea fourtie yeres diddest thou sustaine them in the wilderness, so that	they lacked nothing: their * clothes waxed not old, and their feet swelled not. 22 Moreover, thou gauest them kingdomes and nations, and diddest diuide them into corners: so they possessed the land of * Sihon, and the land of the king of Heshbon, and the land of Og king of Bashan. 23 Their children also multipliedst thou as the starres of heauen, and broughtest them into the land, concerning which thou hadst promised to their fathers, that they should goe in to possesse it. 24 So the children went in, and possessed the land, and thou subduedst before them the inhabitants of the lande, the Canaanites, and gauest them into their hands, with their kings, and the people of the land, that they might doe with them, † as they would. 25 And they tooke strong cities, and a fat land, and possessed houses full of all goods, welles digged, vineyards, and olive yards, and † fruit trees in abundance: So they did eat and were filled, and became fat, and delighted themselves in thy great goodnesse. 26 Neuertheless, they were disobedient, and rebelled against thee, and cast thy law behind their backs, and slew thy * prophets, which testified against them to turne them to thee, and they wrought great prouocations. 27 Therefore thou deliueredst them into the hande of their enemies, who vexed them, & in the time of their trouble, when they cried vnto thee, thou heardest them from heauen: and according to thy manifold mercies, thou gauest them saviours, who saued them out of the hand of their enemies. 28 But after they had rest, † they did euill againe before thee: therefore ledest thou them in the hand of their enemies, so that they had the dominion ouer them: yet when they returned and cried vnto thee, thou heardest them from heauen, and many times didst thou deliuer them, according to thy mercies: 29 And testifiedst against them, that thou mightest bring them againe vnto thy lawe: yet they dealt proudly, and hearkened not vnto thy commandements, but sinned against thy iudgements, (which if a man doe, he shall lue in them) † and withdrew the shoulder, and hardened their necke, and would not heare.	* Deut. 8. 4 * Num. 21. 21. &c. * Heb. according to their will. Or, cisternes † Heb. tree of food. * 1 King. 19. 10. † Heb. they returned to doe euill. † Heb. they gave a withdrawing shoulder.
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† Heb. pro-
trall ouer
them.
* 2. King.
17. 13. 2.
chr. 36. 15.
† Heb. in the
hand of thy
Prophets.

30 Yet many yerres diddest thou † for-
beare them, and testifiedst * against them
by thy Spirit † in thy Prophets: yet
would they not giue eare: therefore ga-
uest thou them into the hand of the peo-
ple of the lands.

31 Neuerthelesse, for thy great mer-
cies sake, thou diddest not bitterly con-
sume them, nor forsake them: for thou
art a gracious and mercifull God.

32 Now therefore, our God, the
great, the * mightie, and the terrible
God, who keepest couenant and mer-
cie: let not all the † trouble seeme little
before thee, † that hath come vpon vs,
on our Kings, on our Princes, & on our
Priests, and on our Prophets, & on our
fathers, & on al thy people, since the time
of the Kings of Assyria, vnto this day.

33 Howbeit, thou art iust in all that is
brought vpon vs, for thou hast done
right, but we haue done wickedly:

34 Neither haue our kings, our
Princes, our Priests, nor our fathers
kept thy Law, nor hearkened vnto thy
Commandements, and thy Testimo-
nies, wherewith thou didst testifie a-
gainst them.

35 For they haue not serued thee in
their kingdome, and in thy great good-
nesse that thou gauest them, and in the
large and fat land which thou gauest
before them, neither turned they from
their wicked workes.

36 Behold, we are seruants this day;
and for the land that thou gauest vnto
our fathers, to eat the fruit thereof, and
the good thereof, behold, wee are ser-
uants in it.

37 And it yeeldeth much increase vnto
the kings, whom thou hast set ouer
vs, because of our sinnes: also they haue
dominion ouer our bodie, and ouer
our cattell, at their pleasure: and wee
are in great distresse.

38 And because of all this, wee make
a sure couenant, and write it, and our
Princes, Leuites, and Priests, † seale
vnto it.

CHAP. X.

1 The names of them that sealed the couenant.

29 The points of the couenant.



OW those † that sealed
were, Nehemiah the Tir-
shatha the sonne of Ha-
chaliah, and Zidkuah,

2 Seraiah, Azariah,
Jeremiah,

3 Pashur, Amariah, Malchiah,
4 Hattuth, Shebaniah, Malluch,
5 Harim, Peremoth, Obadiah,
6 Daniel, Ginnethon, Baruch,
7 Meshullam, Abnah, Mnanun,
8 Maaziah, Bilgai, Shemaiah:
these were the Priests.

9 And the Leuites: both Jeshua
the sonne of Azariah, Binnui, of the
sonnes of Henadad, Kadmiel:

10 And their brethzen, Shebaniah,
Hodniah, Kelita, Delaiah, Hanan,

11 Micah, Rehob, Hashabiah,

12 Zacur, Sherebiah, Shebaniah,

13 Hodniah, Sam, Beninu,

14 The chiefe of the people. Parosh,
Bahath, Hoab, Elam, Zathu, Sam,

15 Binnui, Azgad, Bebai,

16 Adoniah, Bigvai, Adin,

17 Ater, Hizkiah, Azzur,

18 Hodiah, Hashum, Bezai,

19 Hariph, Anathoth, Nebai,

20 Magpiash, Meshullam, Hezir,

21 Meshzabeel, Zadok, Jaddua,

22 Delatah, Hanan, Ananiah,

23 Hoshea, Hananiah, Hashub,

24 Hallohesh, Pileha, Shobek,

25 Rehun, Hashabnah, Maaseiah,

26 And Abnah, Hanan, Anan,

27 Malluch, Harim, Baanah.

28 * And the rest of the people, the
Priests, the Leuites, the Porters, the
singers, the Nethinims, and all they
that had separated themselves from
the people of the lands, vnto the Law
of God, their wiues, their sonnes, and
their daughters, euery one hauing
knowledge, and hauing vnderstand-
ing.

29 They came to their brethzen their
nobles, and entred into a curse, and into
an oath to walke in Gods law, which
was giuen † by Moses the seruant of
God, and to obserue and doe all the
commandements of the LORD our
Lord, and his Judgements, and his
statutes:

30 And that we would not giue * our
daughters vnto the people of the land,
nor take their daughters for our
sonnes.

31 * And if the people of the land bring
ware or any victuals on the Sabbath
day, to sell, that we would not buy it of
them on the Sabbath, or on the holy-
day, and that wee would leaue the
seventh yeere, and the * exaction of eue-
ry debt.

32 Also we made ordinances for vs,
to

* Exo. 34. 6.

† Heb. wea-
rinesse.
† Heb. that
hath found
vs.

* Ezz. 2. 4 3

† Heb. by the
hand of.

† Heb. are
as the sea-
ling, or sea-
led.

* Exo. 4. 16
Leuit. 7. 3.

* Exod. 20.
Leuit. 27.
Leuit. 25.
Leuit. 25.
Leuit. 25.

† Heb. at the
sealing.
|| Or the go-
uernour.

* Deut. 15. 2
Leuit. 25. 4
Leuit. 25. 4
Leuit. 25. 4

to charge our selues peereley, With the third part of a shekel, for the seruice of the house of our God,

33 For the shew-bread, and for the continuall meate-offering, and for the continuall burnt offering, of the Sabbathes, of the new moones, for the feastes, and for the holy things, and for the sin-offerings, to make an atonement for Israel, and for all the worke of the house of our God.

34 And we cast the lots among the priests, the Leuites, and the people, for the wood offering, to bring it into the house of our God, after the houses of our fathers, at times appointed, yeere by yeere, to burne vpon the altar of the LORD our God, as it is written in the *law :

35 And to bring the first fruits of our ground, and the first fruites of all fruit of all trees, yeere by yeere, vnto the house of the LORD.

36 Also the first borne of our sonnes, and of our cattell (as it is written * in the lawe) and the firstlings of our heards, and of our flockes, to bring to the house of our God, vnto the priests that minister in the house of our God :

37 And that we should bring the first fruits of our dough, and our offerings, and the fruit of all maner of trees, of wine and of oyle, vnto the priests, to the chambers of the house of our God, and the tithes of our ground vnto the Leuites, that the same Leuites might haue the tithes, in all the cities of our tillage.

38 And the priest the sonne of Aaron, shall be with the Leuites, * when the Leuites take tithes, and the Leuites shall bring vp the tithes of the tithes vnto the house of our God, to the chambers into the treasure house.

39 For the children of Israel, and the children of Levi, shall bring the offering of the corne, of the new wine, and the oyle, vnto the chambers, where are the vessels of the sanctuarie, and the priests that minister, and the porters, and the singers, and we will not forsake the house of our God.

CHAP. XI.

1 The rulers, voluntary men, and the tenth man chosen by Lot, dwell at Ierusalem. 3 A catalogue of their names. 20 The residue dwell in other cities.



And the rulers of the people dwell at Ierusalem: the rest of the people also cast lots, to bring one of tenne, to dwell in Ierusalem, the holy citie, and nine parts to dwell in other cities.

2 And the people blessed all the men, that willingly offered themselves, to dwell at Ierusalem.

3 Now these are the chiefe of the prouince that dwell in Ierusalem: but in the cities of Iudah dwell euerie one in his possession in their cities, to wit, Israel, the priests, and the Leuites, and the Rethunims, and the children of Solomons seruants.

4 And at Ierusalem dwell certaine of the children of Iudah, and of the children of Benjamin. Of the children of Iudah: Athaiah the sonne of Uzziah, the sonne of Zechariah, the sonne of Amariah, the sonne of Shephatiah, the sonne of Mahalaleel, of the children of Perez.

5 And Baaleiah the sonne of Barchuch the sonne of Col-Hoseh, the sonne of Hazariah the sonne of Adaiah, the sonne of Joiarib, the sonne of Zechariah, the sonne of Shiloni.

6 All the sonnes of Perez that dwell at Ierusalem, were foure hundred threescore and eight valiant men.

7 And these are the sonnes of Benjamin: Sallu the sonne of Meshullam, the sonne of Joed, the sonne of Pedahiah, the sonne of Kolahiah, the sonne of Baaleiah, the sonne of Jithiel, the sonne of Jesaiiah.

8 And after him Gabai, Sallai, nine hundred twentie and eight.

9 And Joel the sonne of Zichri was their ouerleer: and Judah the sonne of Senuah, was second ouer the citie.

10 Of the Priests: Jedaiah the sonne of Joiarib, Jachin

11 Seraiah the sonne of Hilkiah, the sonne of Meshullam, the sonne of Zadok, the sonne of Peraioth, the sonne of Ahirub, was the ruler of the house of God.

12 And their brethren that did the worke of the house, were eight hundred twentie and two: and Adaiah the sonne of Jeroham, the sonne of Pelaiiah, the sonne of Amzi, the sonne of Zechariah, the sonne of Pashur, the sonne of Malchiah,

13 And

* See num. 28. & 19. chap. and Exod. 27. 19. and Leuit. 19. 23.

* Exod. 13. 2. Leuit. 23. 17. num. 15. 19. and 18. 12. &c.

* Num. 18. 26.

13 And his brethren, chiefe of the fathers, two hundred fourty and two: and Amathai the sonne of Azareel, the sonne of Ahasai, the sonne of Meshilemoth, the sonne of Immer.

14 And their brethren mighty men of valour, an hundred twenty and eight: and their ouerleer was Zabbiel, the sonne of one of the great men.

15 Also of the Leuites: Shemaiah the sonne of Hashub, the sonne of Azrikam, the sonne of Hashabiah, the sonne of Bunni.

16 And Shabbethai, and Iozabad, of the chiefe of the Leuits, had the ouersight of the outward businesse of the house of God.

17 And Mattaniah the sonne of Micha, the sonne of Zabdi, the sonne of Asaph, was the principall to beginne the thankesgiuing in prayer: and Bakbukiah the second among his brethren, and Abda the sonne of Shammua, the sonne of Galai, the sonne of Jeduthun.

18 All the Leuites in the holy City, were two hundred, fourescore and foure.

19 Moreover, the porters, Akub, Salmon, and their brethren that kept the gates, were an hundred seventy and two.

20 And the residue of Israel, of the Priests and the Leuites, were in all the cities of Iudah, euery one in his inheritance.

21 * But the Nethinims dwelt in Ophel: and Ziba, and Gipsa were ouer the Nethinims.

22 The ouerleer also of the Leuites at Ierusalem, was Uzzi the sonne of Bani, the son of Hashabiah, the sonne of Mattaniah, the sonne of Micha: Of the sonnes of Asaph, the singers were ouer the businesse of the house of God.

23 For it was the kings commande- ment concerning them, that a certaine portion should be for the singers, due for euery day.

24 And Bethahiah the sonne of Bezababel, of the children of Zerah the sonne of Iudah, was at the kings hand in all matters concerning the people.

25 And for the villages, with their fields, some of the children of Iudah dwelt at Biriath-arba, and in the villages thereof, and at Dibon, and in the villages thereof, and at Jekabzeel, and in the villages thereof:

26 And at Jeshua, and at Moladah, and at Beth-pheret,

27 And at Hazer-Shual, and at Beer-sheba and in the villages thereof:

28 And at Zilag, and at Beke- nah, and in the villages thereof:

29 And at En-Rimmon, and at Zareah, and at Jarmuth,

30 Zanoah, Adullam, and in their villages, at Lachish, and the fields thereof: at Azekah, and in the villages thereof. And they dwelt from Beer-sheba vnto the valley of Humm.

31 The children also of Benjamin, from Geba, dwelt at Michmash, and

32 And at Anathoth. Nob, Ananiah,

33 Hazor, Ramah, Gittaim,

34 Hadid, Zeboim, Neballat,

35 Lod, and Ono, the valley of craftes-men.

36 And of the Leuites, were diuisions in Iudah, and in Benjamin.

CHAP. XII.

1 The Priests, 8 and the Leuites which came vp with Zerubbabel. 10 The succession of his Priests. 22 Certaine chiefe Leuites. 27 The solemnitie of the dedication of the walls. 44 The offices of Priests and Leuites appointed in the Temple.

NOW these are the *Priests and the Leuits that went vp with Zerubbabel the sonne of Shealtiel, and Jeshua: Seraiah, Jeremiah, Ezra,

2 Amariah, Balluch, Battush,

3 Shereaniah, Rehun, Bert-

moth,

4 Iddo, Sinnethe, Abiiah,

5 Miamin, Badiah, Bigah,

6 Shemaiah, Joiarib, Nedabiah,

7 Sallu, Amok, Bilkiah, Jedabiah:

these were the chiefe of the Priests, and of

their brethren in the dayes of Jeshua.

8 Moreover the Leuites: Jeshua, Binnui, Kadmiel, Sherebiah, Judah,

and Mattaniah, which was ouer the thankesgiuing, he and his brethren.

9 Also Bakbukiah, and Ami their brethren, were ouer against them in the watches.

10 And Jeshua begate Joiakim, Joiakim also begate Eliashib, and Eliashib begate Joiada.

11 And Joiada begate Jonathan, and Jonathan begate Jaddua.

12 And in the dayes of Joiakim, were Priests the chiefe of the fathers:

|| Or, of Ge-
ba.

|| Or, 10
Michmash.

* Ezia 2.1.

|| Or, Meli-
ch, ver. 14.

|| Or, Seba-
niah, ver. 14.

|| Or, Harim,
ver. 15.

|| Or, Mera-
ioth, ver. 15.

|| Or, Gume-
thon, ver.
16.

|| Or, Min-
niamin, ver.
17.

|| Or, Afon-
diah, ver. 17.

|| Or, Sallu,
ver. 20.

|| That is,
the Psalmes
of thankes-
giuing.

|| Or, the
sonne of
Haggelo-
dalim.

† Hebr. were
ouer.

† Hebr. at
the gates.

* See Chap.
2. 26.
|| Or, the
tower

|| Or, a fore
ordinance.

of

of Seraiyah, Beraiah: of Jeremiah, Hananiah:

13 Of Ezra, Meshullam: of Amariah, Jehohanan:

14 Of Belicai, Jonathan: of Shebaniah, Joseph:

15 Of Harim, Adna: of Peraioth, Helkai:

16 Of Iddo, Zechariah: of Ginethon, Meshullam:

17 Of Abijah, Zichri: of Benjamin, of Boadiah, Piltai:

18 Of Bilgah, Shammua: of Shebanaiah, Jehonathan:

19 And of Joiarib, Mattaniah: of Jedaiiah, Uzzi:

20 Of Sallai, Ballai: of Amok, Eber:

21 Of Hilkiah, Hashabiah: of Jedaiiah, Bethanael.

22 ¶ The Levites in the dayes of Eliashib, Joiada, and Johanan, and Jaddua, were recorded chiefe of the fathers: also the Priests, to the reigne of Darius the Persian.

23 The sonnes of Levi, the chiefe of the fathers, were written in the booke of the ^{1. Chro. 9.} Chronicles, even vntill the dayes of Johanan the sonne of Eliashib.

24 And the chiefe of the Levites: Hashabiah, Sherebiah, and Jeshua the sonne of Kadmuel, with their brethren ouer against them, to praise and to giue thanks, according to the commandement of Dauid the man of God. Ward ouer against ward.

25 Mattaniah, and Bakbukiah, Obadiah, Meshullam, Talmon, Akkub, were porters keeping the ward, at the thresholds of the gates.

¶ Or, treasures or assemblies.

26 These were in the dayes of Joiakim, the sonne of Jeshua, the sonne of Josadak, and in the dayes of Nehemiah the gouernour, and of Ezra the Priest, the Scribe.

27 ¶ And at the dedication of the wall of Jerusalem, they sought the Levites out of all their places, to bring them to Jerusalem, to keepe the dedication with gladnesse, both with thanksgivings and with singing, with cymbals, psalteries, and with harpes.

28 And the sonnes of the Singers gathered themselves together, both out of the plaine countrey round about Jerusalem, and from the villages of Bethphathi.

29 Also from the house of Gilgal, and out of the fields of Geba, and Az-

maueeth: for the Singers had builded them villages round about Jerusalem.

30 And the Priests and the Levites purified themselves, and purified the people, and the gates, and the wall.

31 Then I brought vp the princes of Judah vpon the wall, and appointed two great companies of them that gaue thanks, whereof one went on the right hand vpon the wall toward the dounge-gate:

32 And after them went Hoshaiah, and halfe of the Princes of Judah,

33 And Azariah, Ezra, and Meshullam,

34 Judah, and Benjamin, and Shebanaiah, and Jeremiah,

35 And certaine of the Priests sonnes with trumpets: namely, Zechariah the sonne of Jonathan, the sonne of Shebanaiah, the sonne of Mattaniah, the sonne of Michaiah, the sonne of Zachur, the sonne of Asaph:

36 And his brethren, Shemaiah, and Asarel, Bilalai, Gilalai, Maai, Bethanael, and Judah, Hanani, with the musickall instruments of Dauid the man of God; and Ezra the Scribe before them.

37 And at the fountaine-gate, which was ouer against them, they went vp by the staires of the citie of Dauid, at the going vp of the wall, aboue the house of Dauid, euen vnto the water-gate, Eastward.

38 And the other company of them that gaue thanks, went ouer against them, and after them, and the halfe of the people vpon the wall, from beyond the towre of the fornares, euen vnto the broad wall,

39 And from aboue the gate of Ephraim, and aboue the olde gate, and aboue the fish-gate, and the towre of Hananeel, and the towre of Meh, euen vnto the shepegate; and they stood still in the prison gate.

40 So stood the two companies of them that gaue thanks in the house of God, and I, and the halfe of the rulers with me:

41 And the Priests: Eliakim, Maaseiah, Miniamin, Michaiah, Elioenai, Zachariah, and Hananiah with trumpets:

42 And Maaseiah, and Shemaiah, and Eleazar, and Uzzi, and Jehohanan, and Malchiah, and Elam, and Ezer. And the Singers † sang loud, with

† Heb. made their voice to be heard.

Jezra:

Jezrahiah their ouerfeer.

43 Also that day they offered great sacrifices, and reioyced: for God had made them reioyce with great ioy: the wiues also and the children reioyced: so that the ioy of Ierusalem was heard euen as farre off.

44 And at that time were some appointed ouer the chambers for the treasures, for the offerings, for the first fruits, and for the tithes, to gather into them out of the fields of the cities the portions of the law for the priests and Levites: for Iudah reioyced for the priests, and for the Levites that waited.

45 And both the fingers and the porters kept the ward of their God, and the ward of the purification, according to the commandement of Dauid, and of Solomon his sonne.

46 For in the dayes of Dauid and Asaph of old, there were chiefe of the fingers, and songs of praise and thanksgiving vnto God.

47 And all Israel in the dayes of Zerubbabel, and in the dayes of Nehemiah, gaue the portions of the fingers, and the porters, euery day his portion, and they sanctified holy things vnto the Levites, and the Levites sanctified them vnto the children of Aaron.

CHAP. XIII.

1 Vpon the reading of the Law, separation is made from the mixed multitude. 4 Nehemiah at his returne, causeth the chambers to bee cleansed. 10 He reformeth the offices in the house of God. 15 The violation of the Sabbath, 23 & the mariages with strange wiues.

¶ That day they read in the booke of Moyses in the audience of the people, and therein was found written, that the Ammonite and the Moabite should not come into the Congregation of God for ever, because they met not the children of Israel with bread, and with water, but hired Balaam against them, that he should curse them: howbeit our God turned the curse into a blessing.

3 Now it came to passe when they had heard the law, that they separated from Israel all the mixed multitude.

4 And before this Elishah the priest hauing the ouersight of the chamber of the house of our God, was allied vnto Tobiah:

5 And hee had prepared for him a great chamber, where aforetime they laid the meat offerings, the frankincense and the vessels, and the tithes of the corne, the new wine, and the oyle, which was commanded to be giuen to the Levites, and the fingers, and the porters, and the offerings of the priests.

6 But in all this time was not I at Ierusalem: for in the two and thirtieth yeere of Artaxerxes king of Babylon, came I vnto the king, and after certaine dayes, obtained I leaue of the King:

7 And I came to Ierusalem, and vnderstood of the euil that Elishah did for Tobiah, in preparing him a chamber in the courts of the house of God.

8 And it grieved me sore, therefore I cast forth all the household stuffe of Tobiah out of the chamber:

9 Then I commanded, and they cleansed the chambers, and thither brought I againe the vessels of the house of God, with the meate offering, and the frankincense.

10 And I perceiued that the portions of the Levites had not bene giuen them: for the Levites and the fingers that did the worke, were fled euery one to his field.

11 Then contended I with the rulers, and said, why is the house of God forsaken: And I gathered them together, and set them in their place.

12 Then brought all Iudah the tithe of the corne, and the new wine, and the oyle, vnto the treasures.

13 And I made treasurers ouer the treasures, Shelemiah the priest, and Zadok the scribe, and of the Levites, Bedaiah: and next to them was Hanan the sonne of Zaccur, the sonne of Nataniah: for they were counted faithfull, and their office was to distribute vnto their brethren.

14 Remember me, O my God, concerning this, and wipe not out my good deeds, that I haue done for the house of my God, and for the offices thereof.

15 In those dayes saue I in Iudah, some treading wine presses on the Sabbath, and bringing in sheaves, and lading asses, as also wine, grapes, and figs, and all manner of burdens, which they brought into Ierusalem on the Sabbath day: and I testified against them in the day wherein they solde vituals.

† Hebr. she commanded-
ment of the
Leuites.

† Heb. at the
end of daies
|| Or, I ear-
nestly reque-
sted.

† Heb. stand-
ing.

|| Or, store-
houses.

† Hebr. at
their hand.

† Heb. it was
upon them.

* Verſe 22.

† Heb. kind-
ness.
|| Or, obser-
uations.

|| That is, ap-
pointed by
the law.
† Hebr. for
the ioy of
Iudah.
† Heb. that
stood.
1. Chron.
24. and 25.
chap.
* 1. Chron.
25. 1. &c.

|| That is, set
apart.
* Num. 18.
26.

† Heb. there
was read.
* Num. 22.
5. deut. 23. 3
† Heb. eares

* Num. 22.
5. 10th. 24. 9

† Heb. being
set ouer.

Abuse of the Nehemiah. Sabbath, reformed.

16 There dwelt men of Tyre also therein, which brought fish and all manner of ware, and sold on the Sabbath unto the children of Judah, and in Jerusalem.

17 Then I contended with the Nobles of Judah, and sayd vnto them, what euill thing is this that ye doe, and profane the Sabbath day:

18 Did not your fathers thus, and did not our God bring all this euill vpon vs. and vpon this citie: yet ye bring more wrath vpon Israel, by profaning the Sabbath.

19 And it came to passe, that when the gates of Jerusalem beganne to be darke before the Sabbath, I commanded that the gates should be shut, and charged that they should not be opened till after the Sabbath: and some of my seruants set I at the gates, that there should no burden be brought in on the Sabbath day.

20 So the merchants, and sellers of all kinde of ware, lodged without Jerusalem once or twice.

† Heb. b. before the wall.

21 Then I testified against them, and said vnto them, why lodge yee † about the wall: If ye doe so againe, I will lay hands on you. From that time forth came they no more on the Sabbath.

22 And I commanded the Leuites, that they should cleanse themselves, and that they should come and keepe the gates, to sanctifie the Sabbath day: Remember me, O my God, concerning this also, and spare me, according to the greatnesse of thy mercie.

|| Or, multi- tude.

23 ¶ In those dayes also sawe I

Jewes that † had married wiues of Ashdod, of Annon, and of Doab:

† Heb. had made to dwell with them.

24 And their children spake halfe in the speech of Ashdod, and † could not speake in the Jewes language, but according to the language † of ech people.

† Heb. they discerned not to speake.

25 And I contended with them, and || cursed them, and smote certeine of them, and pluckt off their haire, and made them sweare by God, saying, Wee shall not giue your daughters vnto their sonnes, nor take their daughters vnto your sonnes, or for your selues.

† Heb. of people and people. || Or, reuiled them.

26 Did not Solomon king of Israel sinne by these things: yet among many nations was there no king like him, who was beloued of his God, and God made him king ouer all Israel: * neuerthelesse, euen him did outlandish women cause to sinne.

* 1. King. 11 1, &c.

27 Shall wee then hearken vnto you, to doe all this great euill, to transgresse against our God, in marryng strange wiues:

28 And one of the sonnes of Joiada, the sonne of Eliashib the high Priest, was sonne in law to Sanballat the Horonite: therefore I chased him from me.

29 Remember them, O my God, † because they haue defiled the Priesthood, and the couenant of the Priesthood, and of the Leuites.

† Heb. for the defiling.

30 Thus cleansed I them from all strangers, and appointed the wards of the Priests and the Leuites, every one in his businesse:

31 And for the wood-offering, at times appointed, and for the first fruits. Remember me, O my God, for good.

THE



THE BOOKE OF Esther.

CHAP. I.

1 Ahasuerus maketh royall feasts. 10 Vasthi, sent for, refuseth to come. 13 Ahasuerus, by the counsell of Memucan, maketh the decree of mens soueraignie.

NOW it came to passe in the dayes of Ahasuerus, (this is Ahasuerus which reigned from India, even vnto Ethiopia, ouer an hundred, and tenen and twentie prouinces.)

2 That in those dayes, when the King Ahasuerus sat on the throne of his kingdome, which was in Shushan the palace :

3 In the third yere of his reigne, he made a feast vnto all his Princes, and his seruants, the power of Persia and Media, the Nobles and Princes of the prouinces being before him.

4 When he shewed the riches of his glorious kingdome, and the honour of his excellent maiestie, many dayes, even an hundred and fourescore dayes.

5 And when these dayes were expired, the king made a feast vnto all the people that were † present in Shushan the palace, both vnto great and small, seven dayes, in the court of the garden of the kings palace,

6 Where were white, greene and ‖ blew hangings, fastened with cords of fine linnen, and purple, to siluer rings, and pillars of marble: the beds were of gold and siluer, vpon a pauement of ‖ red, and blew, and white, and blacke marble.

7 And they gaue them drinke in vessels of gold, (the vessels being diuers one from another) and † royall wine in

abundance, according to the † state of the king.

8 And the drinking was according to the law, none did compell: for the king had appoynted to all the officers of his house, that they should doe according to euery mans pleasure.

9 Also Vasthi the Queene made a feast for the women, in the royall house which belonged to king Ahasuerus.

10 On the seventh day, when the heart of the King was merry with wine, he commanded Methuman, Biztha, Harbona, Bigtha, and Abagtha, Zethar, and Cartas, the seven ‖ chamberlens that serued in the presence of Ahasuerus the king,

11 To bring Vasthi the Queene before the king, with the Crowne royall, to shew the people, and the Princes her beautie: for she was † faire to looke on.

12 But the Queene Vasthi refused to come at the Kings commandement † by his chamberlens: therefore was the King very wroth, and his anger burned in him.

13 Then the king saide to the wise men, which knew the times (for so was the Kings maner towards all that knew law, and iudgement :

14 And the next vnto him, was Carshena, Shethar, Admatha, Tarshis, Meres, Martena, and Memucan, the seven * Princes of Persia, and Media, which saw the Kings face, and which sat the first in the kingdome.)

15 † What shall wee doe vnto the Queene Vasthi, according to law, because she hath not performed the commandement of the king Ahasuerus, by the chamberlens :

16 And Memucan answered before the king and the Princes: Vasthi the Queene hath not done wrong to the king onely, but also to all the Princes, and to all the people that are in all the

† Heb. according to the
law of the
king.

† Or. Eunuchs.

† Heb. good
of com-
mence.

† Heb.
which was
in the hand
of his Eunuchs.

* Ezra 7.14.

† Heb. what
to doe?

† Heb.
found.

‖ Or. violet.

‖ Or. of por-
phyre, and
marble, and
alabaster,
and stone of
blew colour.
† Heb. wine
of the king-
dome.

Vasthi put away. Esther. The kings decree.

provinces of the king Ahasuerus.

17 For this deed of the queene shall come abroad vnto all women, so that they shall despise their husbands in their eyes, When it shall bee reported; The king Ahasuerus commanded Vasthi the queene to be brought in before him, but she came not.

18 Likewise shall the Ladies of Persia and Media say this day vnto all the kings princes, which haue heard of the deed of the Queene. Thus shall there arise too much contempt and wrath.

19 † If it please the king, let there go a royall commandement † from him, and let it bee written among the lawes of the Persians, and the Medes, † that it be not altered, that Vasthi come no more before king Ahasuerus, and let the king giue her royall estate † vnto another that is better then she.

20 And when the kings decree, which he shall make, shall be published throughout all his empire, (for it is great:) all the wiues shall giue to their husbands honour, both to great and small.

21 And the saying † pleased the king and the princes, and the king did according to the word of Memucan:

22 For he sent letters into all the kings provinces, into euery province, according to the writing thereof, and to euery people after their language, that euery man should beare rule in his owne house, and † that it should be published according to the language of euery people.

CHAP. II.

1 Out of the choise of virgines, a Queene is to be chosen. 5 Mordecai the nursing father of Esther. 8 Esther is preferred by Hegai before the rest. 12 The maner of purification, & going in to the king. 15 Esther best pleasing the king, is made Queene. 21 Mordecai discovering a treason, is recorded in the Chronicles.

After these things, when the wrath of king Ahasuerus was appeased, hee remembered Vasthi, and what shee had done, and what was decreed against her.

2 Then saide the kings seruants, that ministered vnto him, Let there bee faire yong virgins sought for the king:

3 And let the king appoint officers in all the provinces of his kingdome, that they may gather together all the

faire yong virgins vnto Shushan the palace, to the house of the women † vnto the custodie of † Hegai the kings chamberlaine, keeper of the women, and let their things for purification bee giuen them:

4 And let the maiden which pleaseth the king, bee Queene in stead of Vasthi. And the thing pleased the king, and hee did so.

5 ¶ Now in Shushan the palace, there was a certaine Jew, whose name was Mordecai, the sonne of Jair, the sonne of Shimei, the sonne of Kish, a Beniamite,

6 * who had bene carried away from Jerusalem, with the captiuitie which had bene carried away with Jeroniah king of Iudah, whom Nebuchadnezzar the King of Babylon had carried away.

7 And hee † brought by Hadassah (that is Esther) his vnckles daughter, for she had neither father nor mother, and the maid was † faire and beautiful, whom Mordecai (when her father and mother were dead) tooke for his owne daughter.

8 ¶ So it came to passe, when the kings commandement and his decree was heard, and when many maidens were gathered together vnto Shushan the palace, to the custodie of Hegai, that Esther was brought also vnto the kings house, to the custodie of Hegai, keeper of the women.

9 And the maiden pleased him, and she obtained kindnesse of him, and hee speedily gaue her her things for purification, with † such things as belonged to her, and seuen maidens, which were meet to be giuen her, out of the kings house, and † hee preferred her and her maids, vnto the best place of the house of the women.

10 Esther had not shewed her people, nor her kindred: for Mordecai had charged her, that she should not shew it.

11 And Mordecai walked euery day before the court of the womens house, † to know how Esther did, and what should become of her.

12 ¶ Now when euery maids turne was come, to goe in to King Ahasuerus, after that shee had bene twelue moneths, according to the maner of the women (for so were the dayes of their purifications accomplished, to wit, sixe moneths with oile of myrrhe, and sixe moneths

† Heb. if it be good with the king.
† Heb. from before him.
† Heb. that it passe not away.
† Heb. vnto her companion.

† Heb. was good in the eyes of the king.

† Heb. that one should publish it according to the language of this people.

† Heb. vnto the hand.
|| Or. Hegai, ver. 8.

* 2. King. 24
† 5. ier. 24. 1 and 2. chio. 36. 10.

† Heb. nourished.

† Heb. faire of fourme, and good of countenance.

† Heb. her portions.

† Heb. hee changed her.

† Heb. to know the secret.

moneths with sweet odours, and with other things for the purifying of the women.)

13 Then thus came every maiden vnto the king, whatsoeuer she desired, was giuen her, to goe with her out of the house of the women, vnto the kings house.

14 In the euening she went, and on the morrowe she returned into the second house of the women, to the custodie of Shaathgaz the kings chamberlen, which kept the concubines: shee came in vnto the king no more, except the king delighted in her, and that shee were called by name.

15 Now when the turne of Esther, the daughter of Abihail, the vncle of Mordecai (who had taken her for his daughter) was come, to goe in vnto the king: she required nothing, but what hegai the kings chamberlen the keeper of the women, appointed: And Esther obtained fauour in the sight of all them that looked vpon her.

16 So Esther was taken vnto king Ahasuerus, into his house royall, in the tenth moneth (which is the moneth Tebeth) in the seuenth yeere of his reigne.

17 And the king loued Esther aboue all the women, and she obtained grace and fauour in his sight, more then all the virgins: so that hee set the royall crowne vpon her head, and made her queene, in stead of Vasthi.

18 Then the king made a great feast vnto all his princes and his seruants, euen Esthers feast, and hee made a release to the prouinces, and gaue gifts, according to the state of the king.

19 And when the virgins were gathered together the second time, then Mordecai sate in the kings gate.

20 Esther had not yet shewed her kindred, nor her people, as Mordecai had charged her: For Esther did the commandement of Mordecai, like as when she was brought vp with him.

21 In those dayes, (while Mordecai sate in the kings gate) two of the kings chamberlens, Bigthan and Teresh, of those which kept the doore, were wroth, and sought to lay hand on the king Ahasuerus:

22 And the thing was knowen to Mordecai, who told it vnto Esther the Queene, and Esther certified the king thereof, in Mordecais name.

23 And when inquisition was made

of the matter, it was found out, therfore they were both hanged on a tree: and it was written in the booke of the chronicles before the king.

CHAP. III.

1 Haman aduanced by the king, and despised by Mordecai, seeketh reuenge vpon all the Iewes. 7 Hee casteth Lots. 8 Hee obtaineth by calumination, a Decree of the king, to put the Iewes to death.



fter these things did king Ahasuerus promote Haman, the sonne of Amedatha the Agagite, and aduanced him, and set his seate aboue all the princes that were with him.

2 And all the kings seruants, that were in the kings gate, bowed, and reuerenced Haman, for the king had so commanded concerning him: but Mordecai bowed not, nor did him reuerence.

3 Then the kings seruants, which were in the kings gate, sayd vnto Mordecai, why transgressest thou the kings commandement:

4 Now it came to passe, when they spake daily vnto him, and he hearkened not vnto them: that they told Haman, to see whether Mordecai his matters would stand, for he had told them that he was a Iewe.

5 And when Haman saw that Mordecai bowed not, nor did him reuerence, then was Haman full of wrath.

6 And hee thought scorne to lay hands on Mordecai alone, for they had shewed him the people of Mordecai: wherefore Haman sought to destroy all the Iewes, that were throughout the whole kingdome of Ahasuerus, euen the people of Mordecai.

7 In the first moneth (that is, the moneth Nisan) in the twelfth yeere of king Ahasuerus, they cast pur, that is, the lot, before Haman, from day to day, and from moneth to moneth, to the twelfth moneth, that is the moneth Adar.

8 And Haman saide vnto king Ahasuerus: There is a certaine people scattered abroad, and dispersed among the people, in all the prouinces of thy kingdome, and their lawes are diuerse from all people, neither keepe they the kings lawes: therefore it is not for the kings profit to suffer them.

† Heb. meese
or, equall.

|| Or, kind-
ness.
† Heb. be-
fore him.

† Heb. re?

|| Or, Big-
than, Chap.
6.2.
† Heb. the
three hold.